

ISSUE
#1

FAITH • GRIT
& GROWING UP

LEXINGTON

THE TURNAROUND

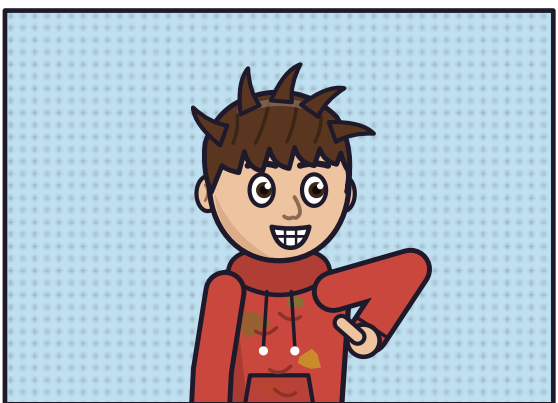


SMART KID. DUMB CHOICES.
ONE BIG TURNAROUND.

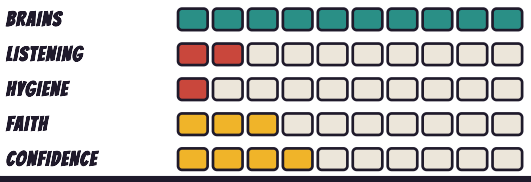
MEET THE CAST

LEXINGTON

AGE 13

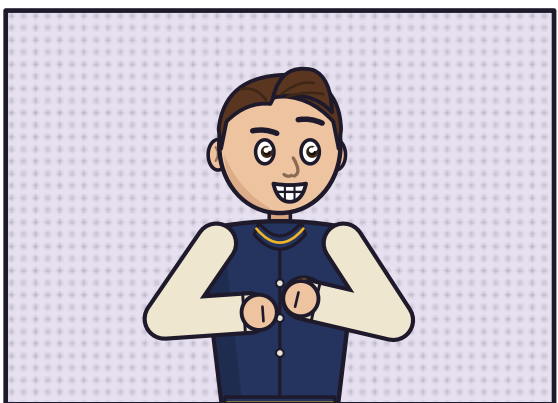


Genius brain. Builds robots for fun.
Also forgets to shower for days.

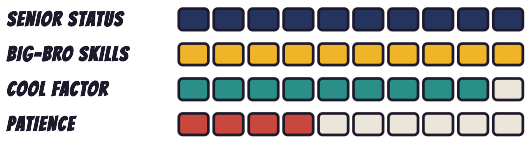


BIG TONY

AGE 18 • SENIOR

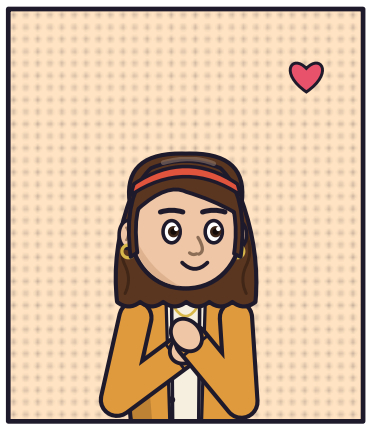


Lexington's big brother. High school senior. Almost out the door.



MOM

CHIEF OF EVERYTHING

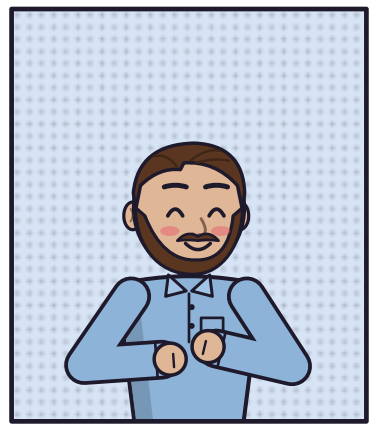


Loves hard. Prays harder.
Smells trouble two rooms away.



DAD

BUILDER • COACH

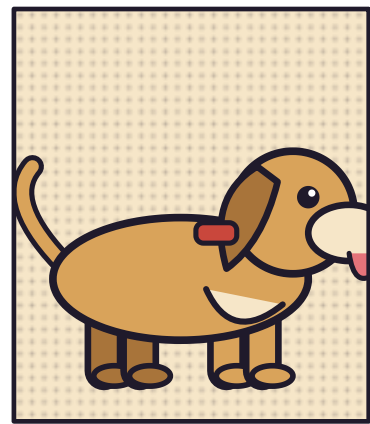


Built the chore chart.
Will build ten more if he has to.



BISCUIT

GOOD DOG



Family dog. Pro sniffer.
Strong opinions about smells.



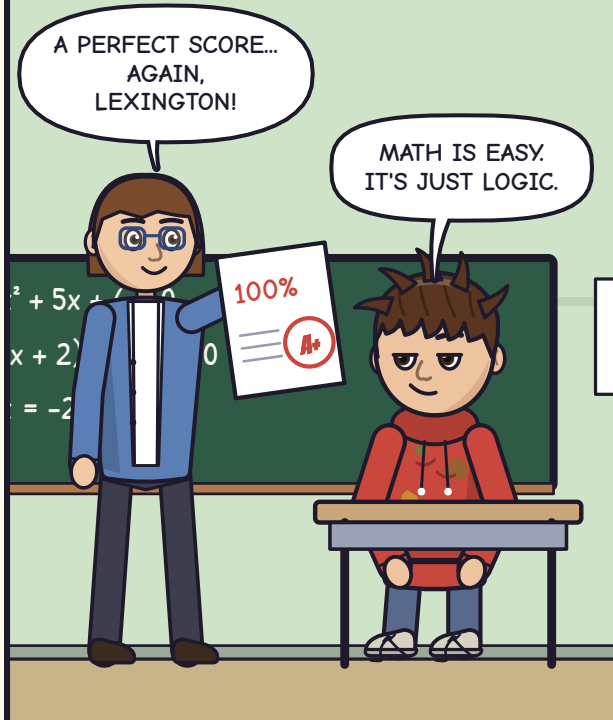
For every kid who is smart enough to choose better,
and for the parents who never stop praying.

Meet **Lexington**. Thirteen years old.

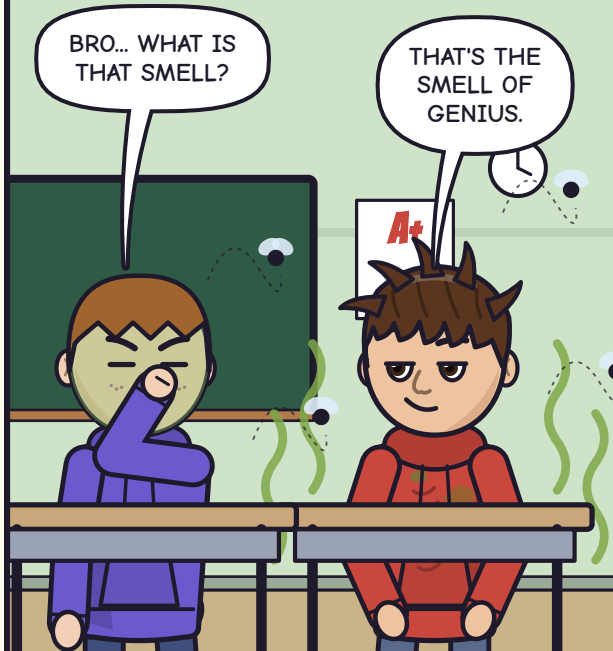
Over **ONE** weekend, he turned Mom's old vacuum cleaner into a working robot.

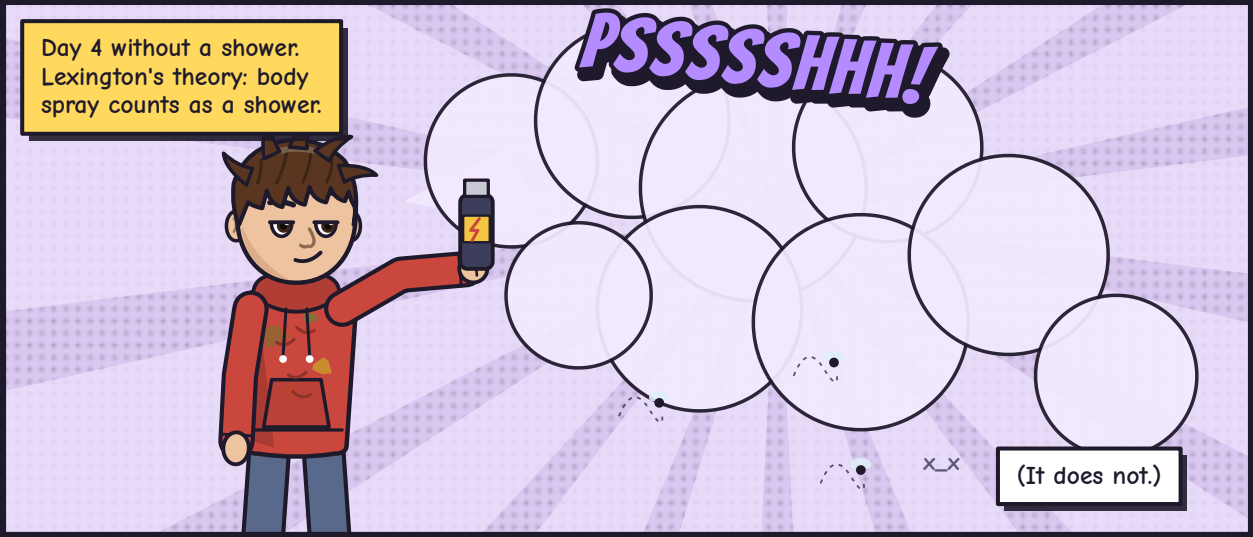


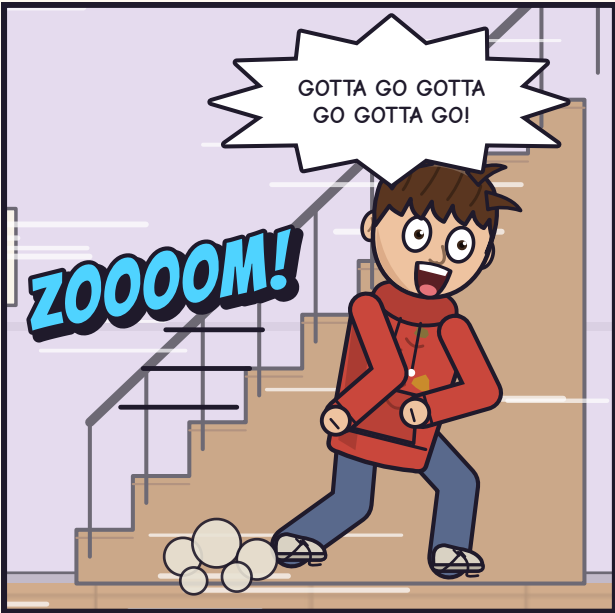
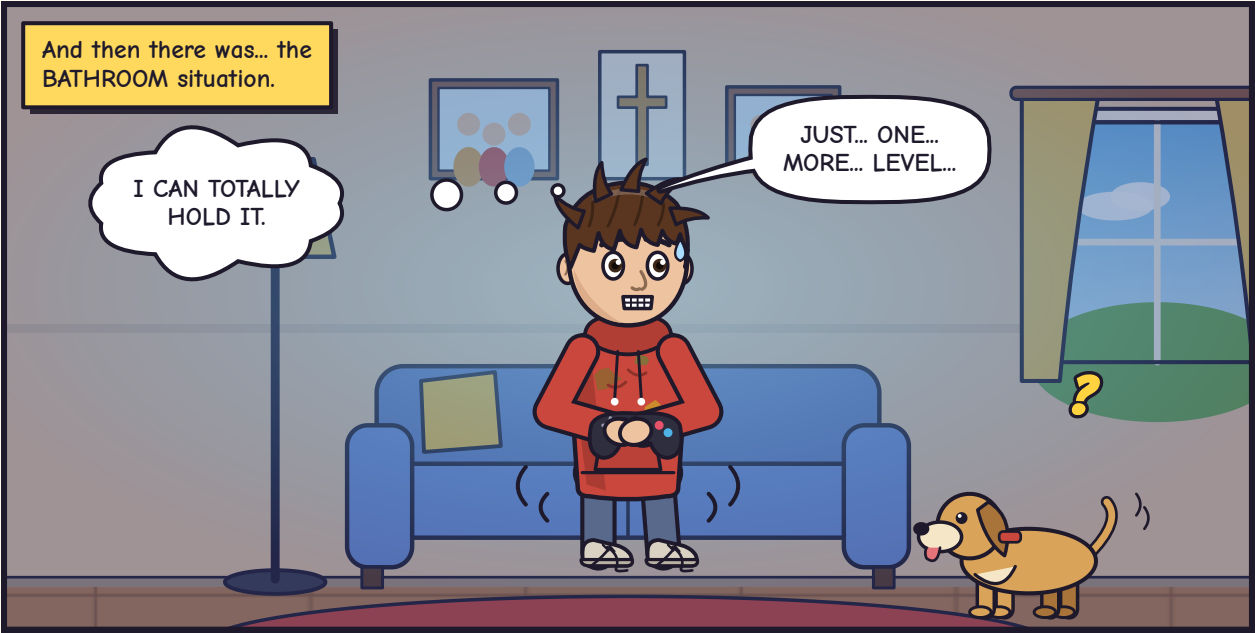
He aces every math test. Without studying.



But somehow, a kid **THIS** smart could **NOT** remember to take a shower.







That night, Mom and Dad made a plan.

HE'S SO SMART. WHY CAN'T HE REMEMBER THE SIMPLE STUFF?

THEN WE MAKE THE SIMPLE STUFF IMPOSSIBLE TO FORGET.

CHORE CHART: CHECK.

LEX'S CHORES

Make bed	
Trash	
Dishes	
Laundry	
Feed Biscuit	

BZZZT!

FRESH START KIT: CHECK.

FRESH START KIT

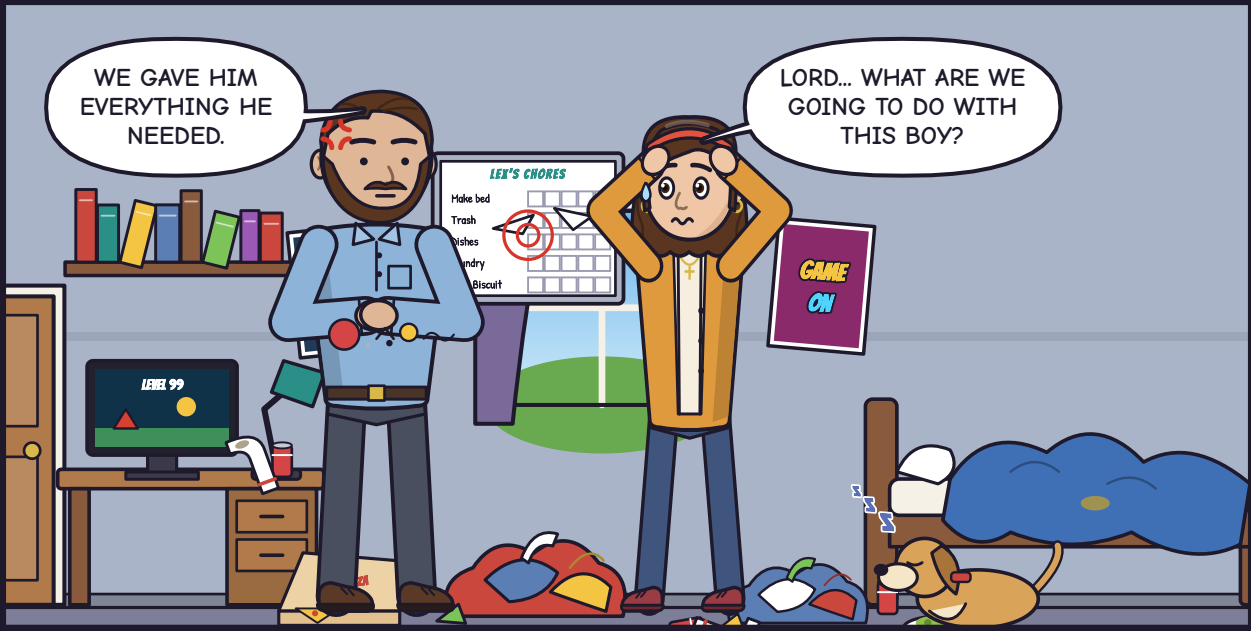
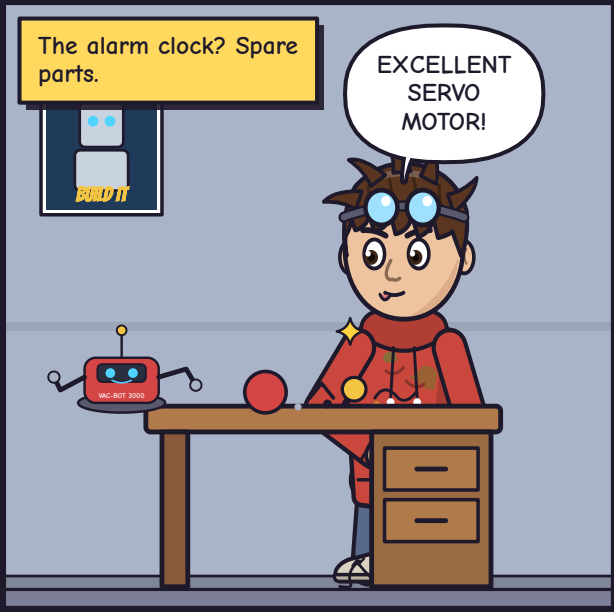
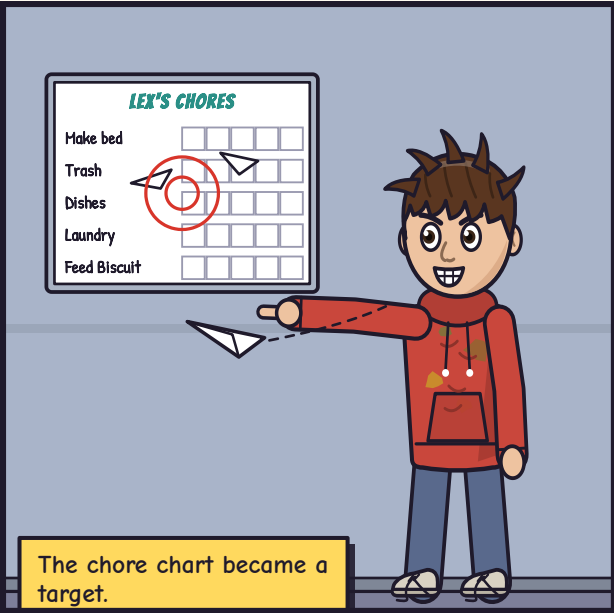
TA-DA!

LEX'S
Make bed
Trash
Dishes
Laundry
Feed Biscuit

WHOA...
THANKS!

They set Lexington up for success.

So, naturally... he did the exact OPPOSITE.



His name got yelled so much, it practically echoed.

LEXINGTON!!!

LEXINGTON!

LEXINGTON?!

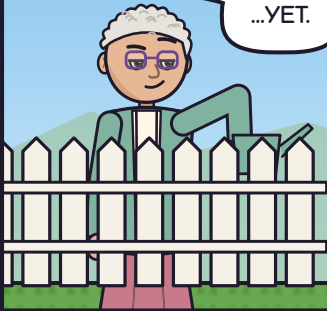
LEX! THAT'S MY HOODIE!



WHAT DID YOU DO THIS TIME, LEXINGTON?

I HAVEN'T DONE ANYTHING YET TODAY!

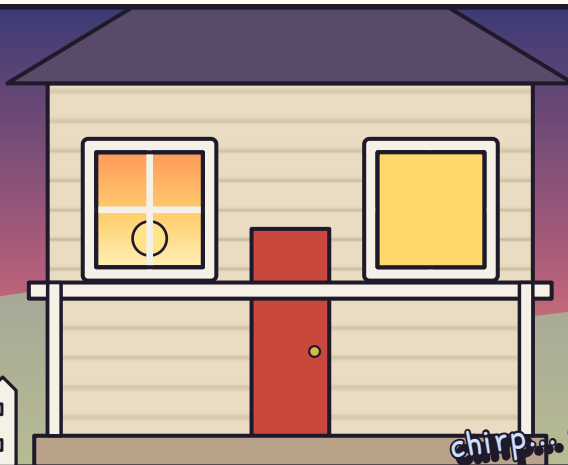
...YET.



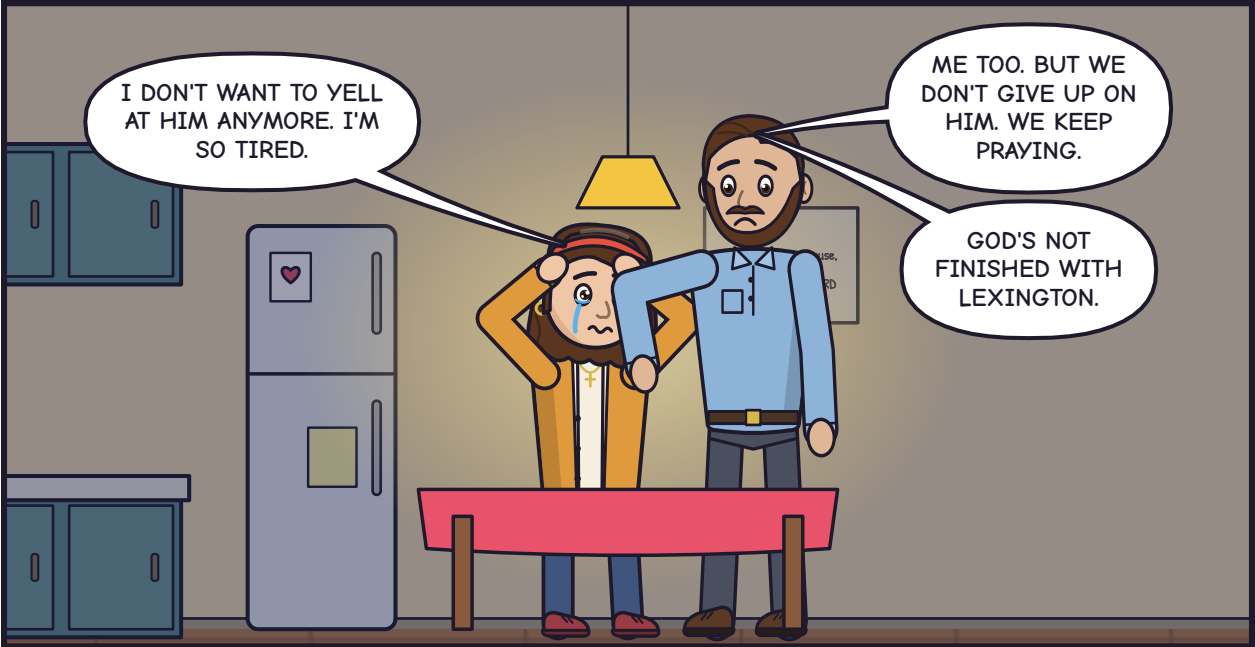
ROOM. NOW I'LL BE UP IN A MINUTE.

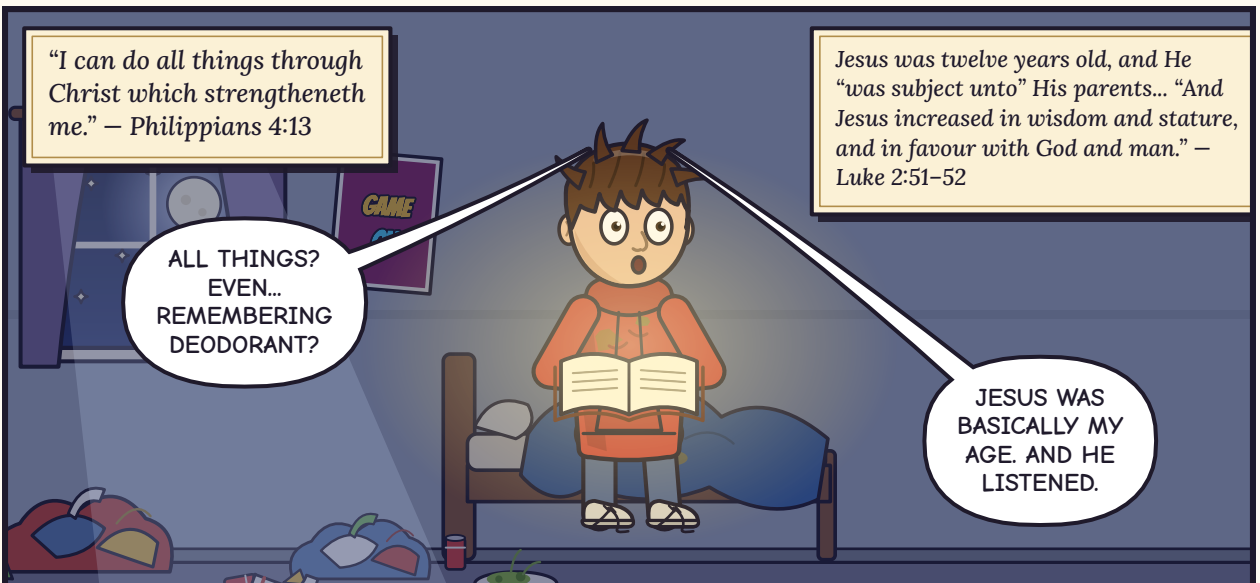
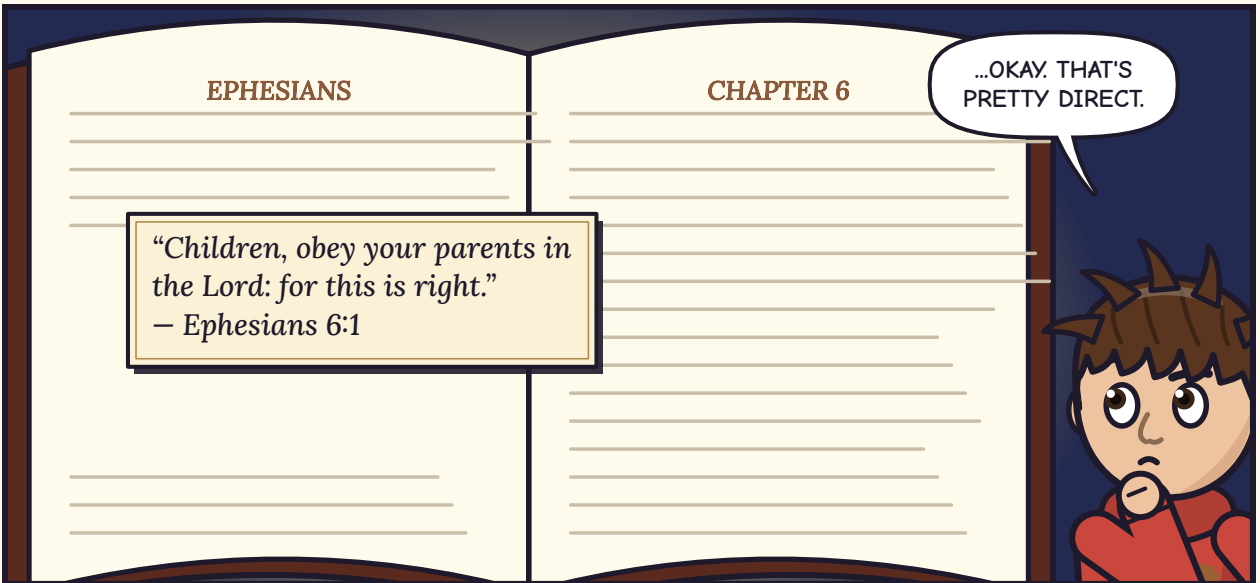


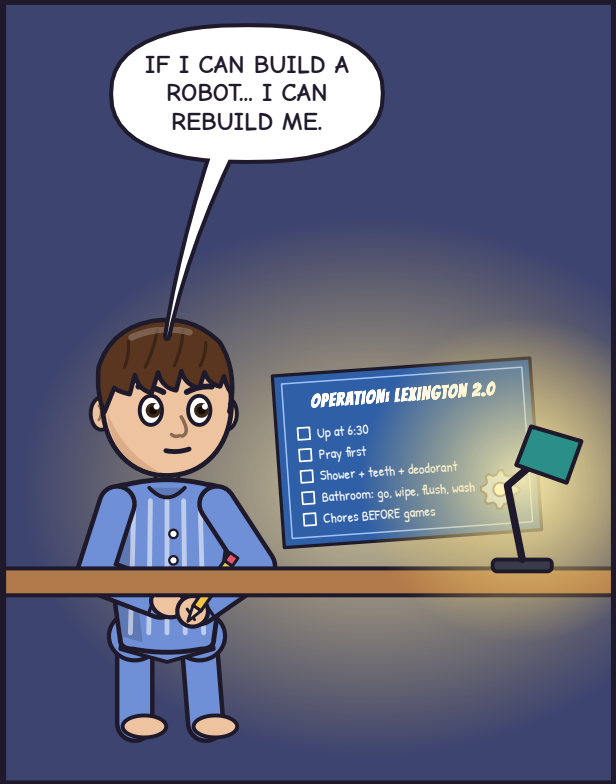
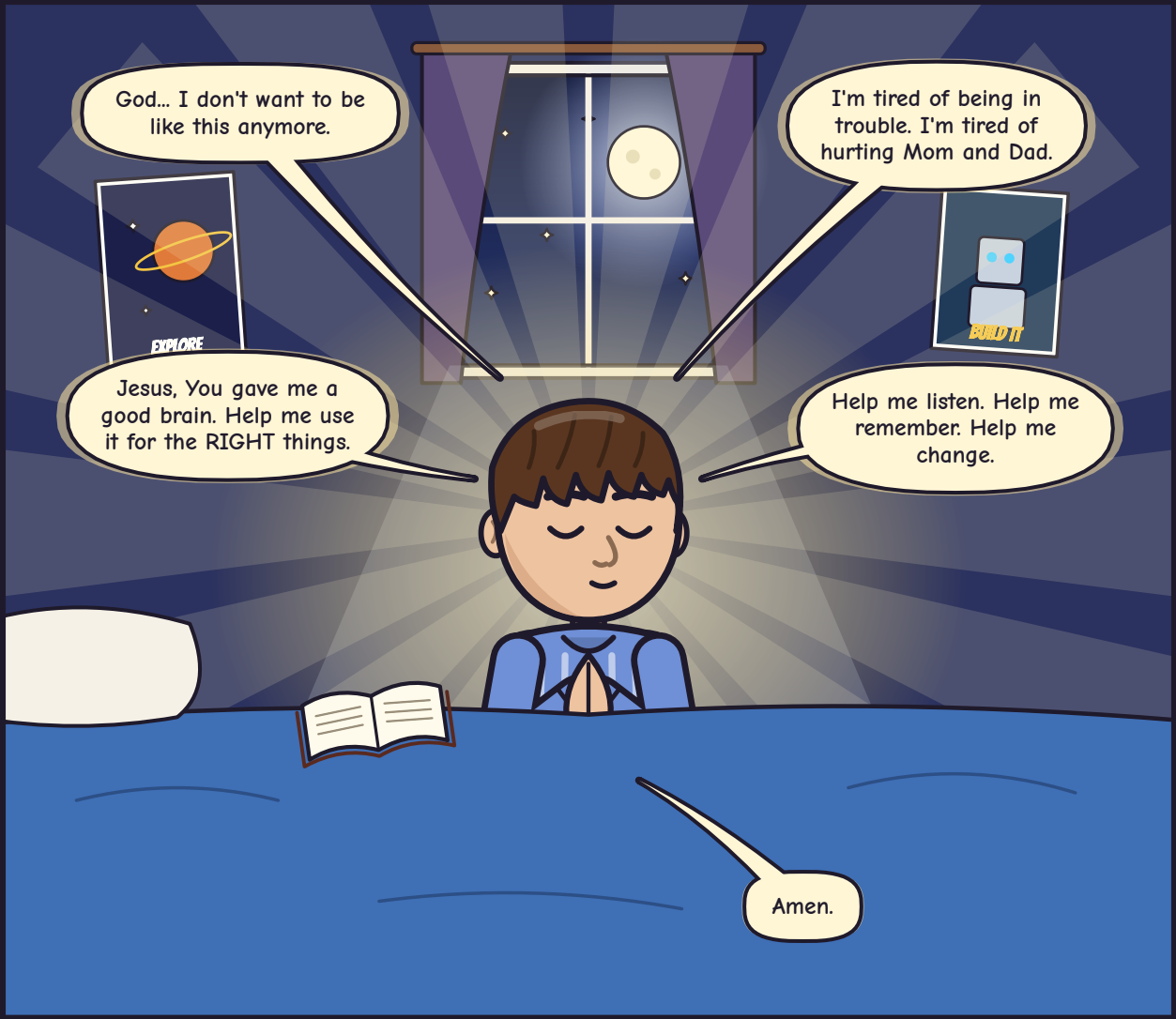
By March, Lexington had gotten more whoopings than he had clean socks.

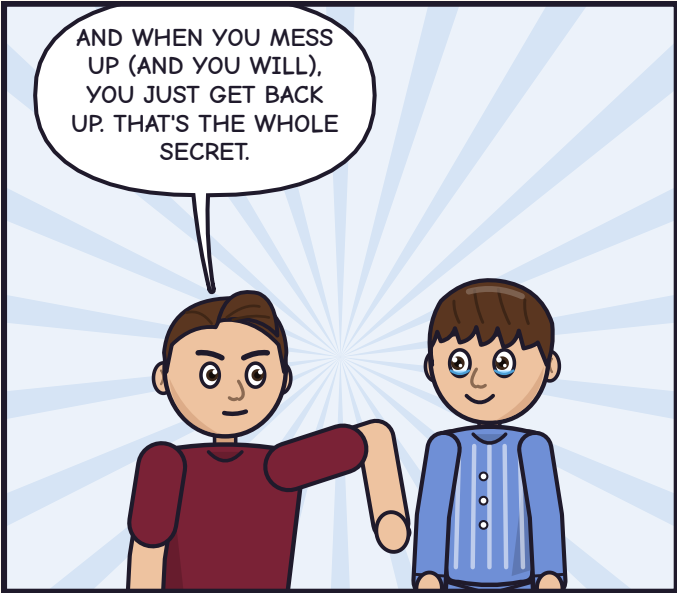
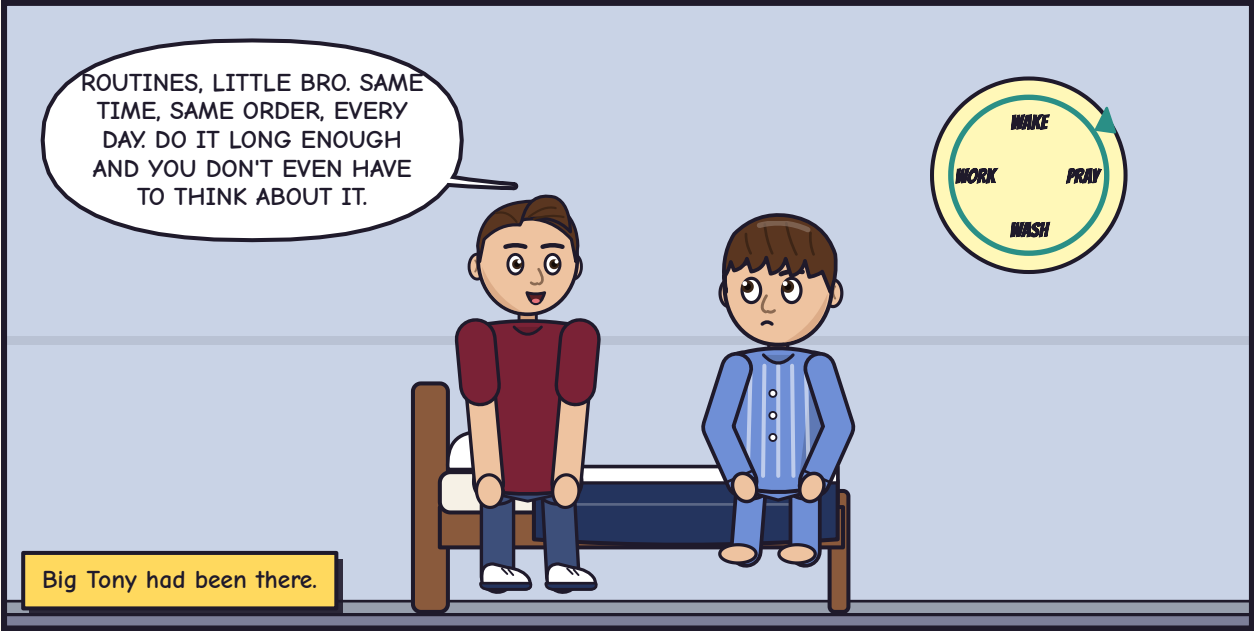
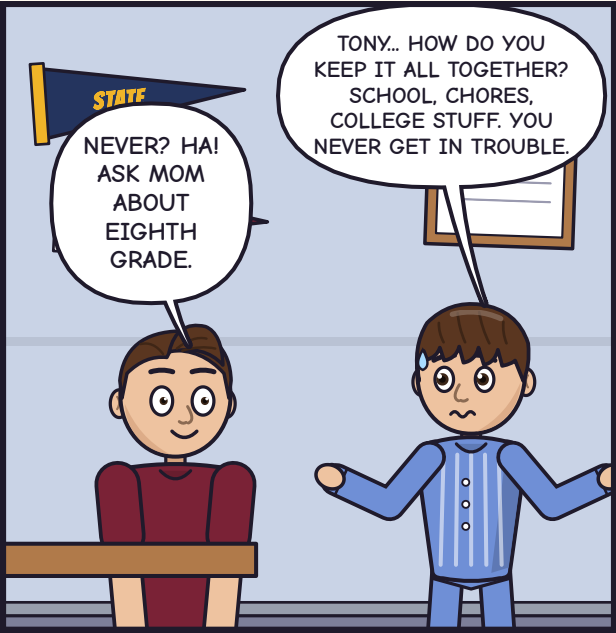
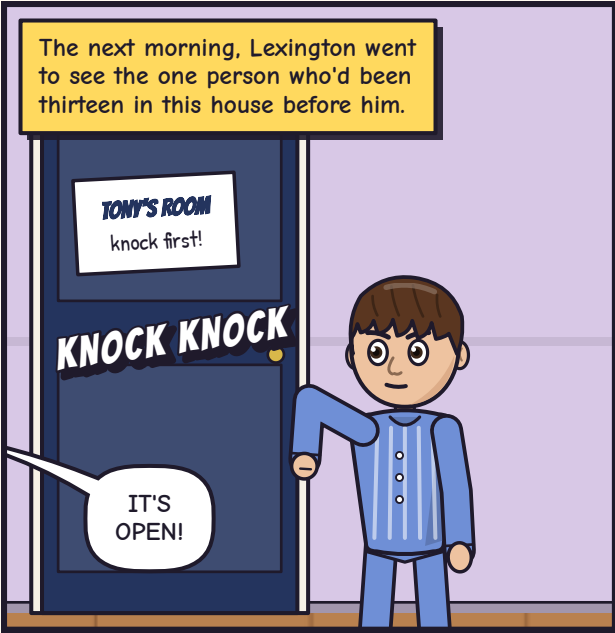


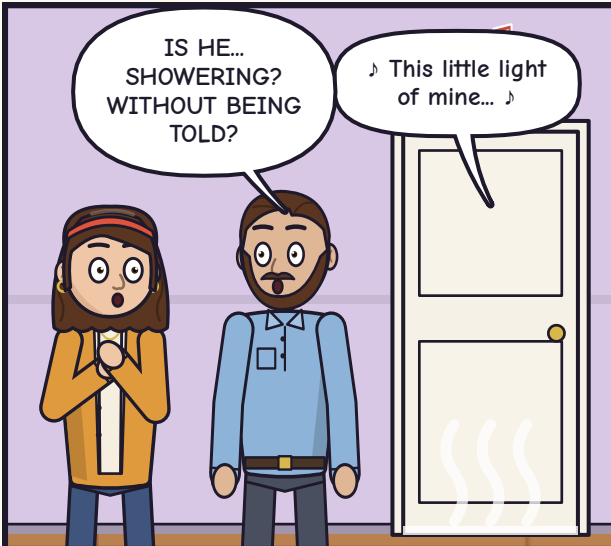
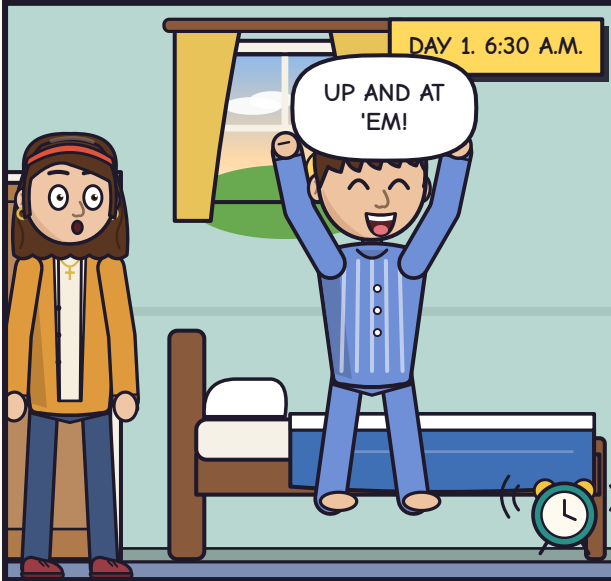
chirp... chirp...

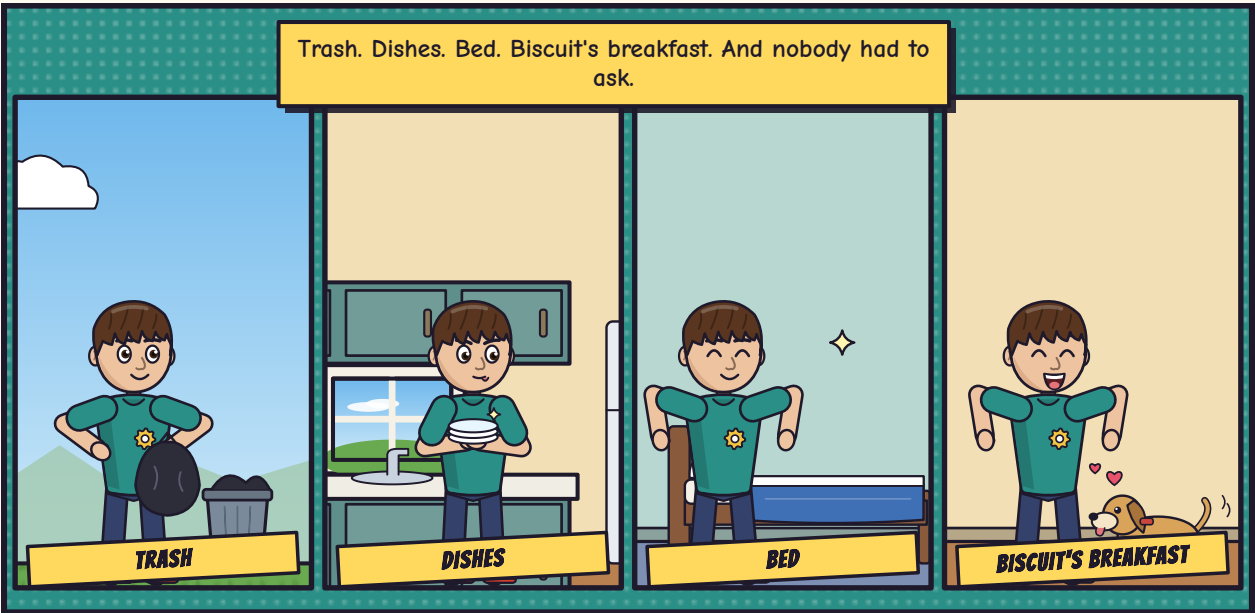
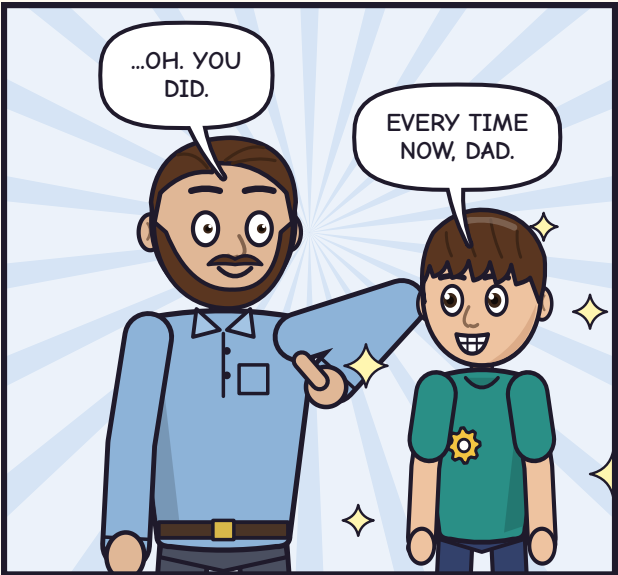


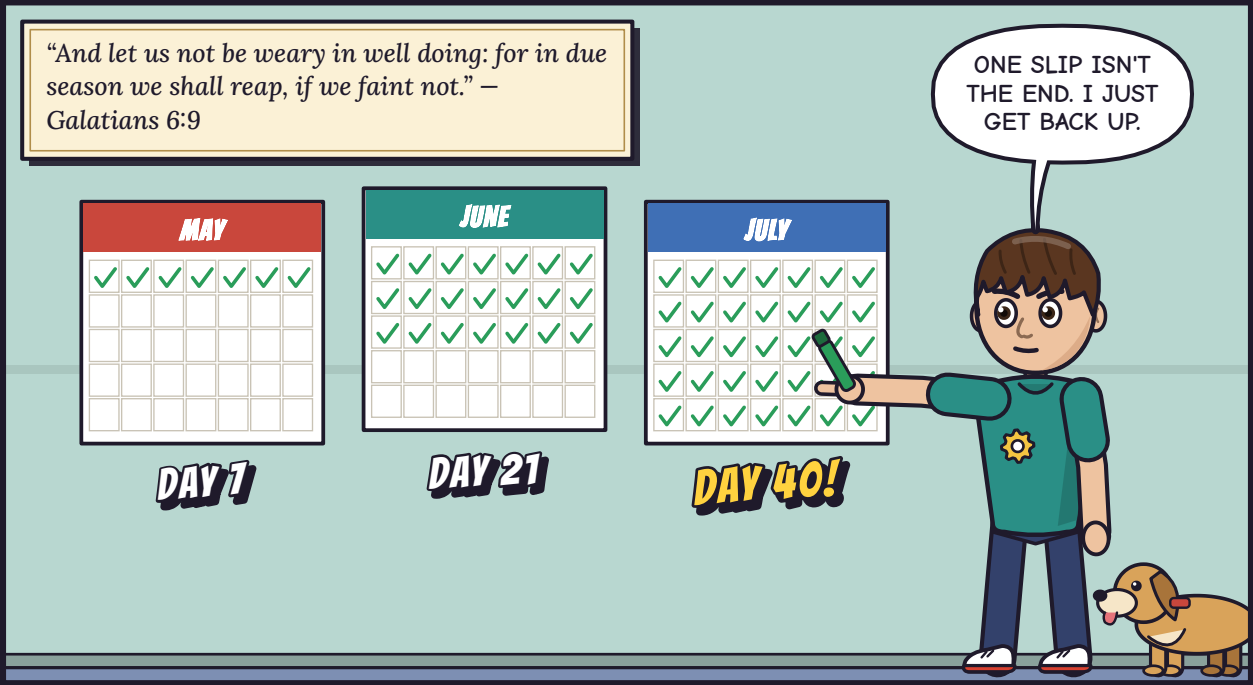
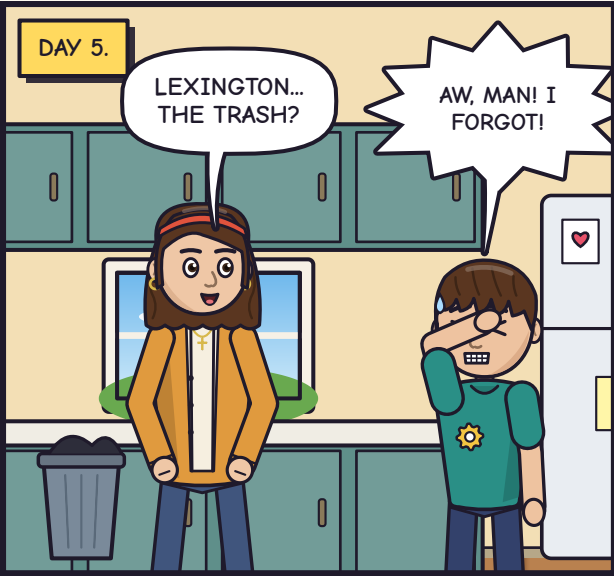








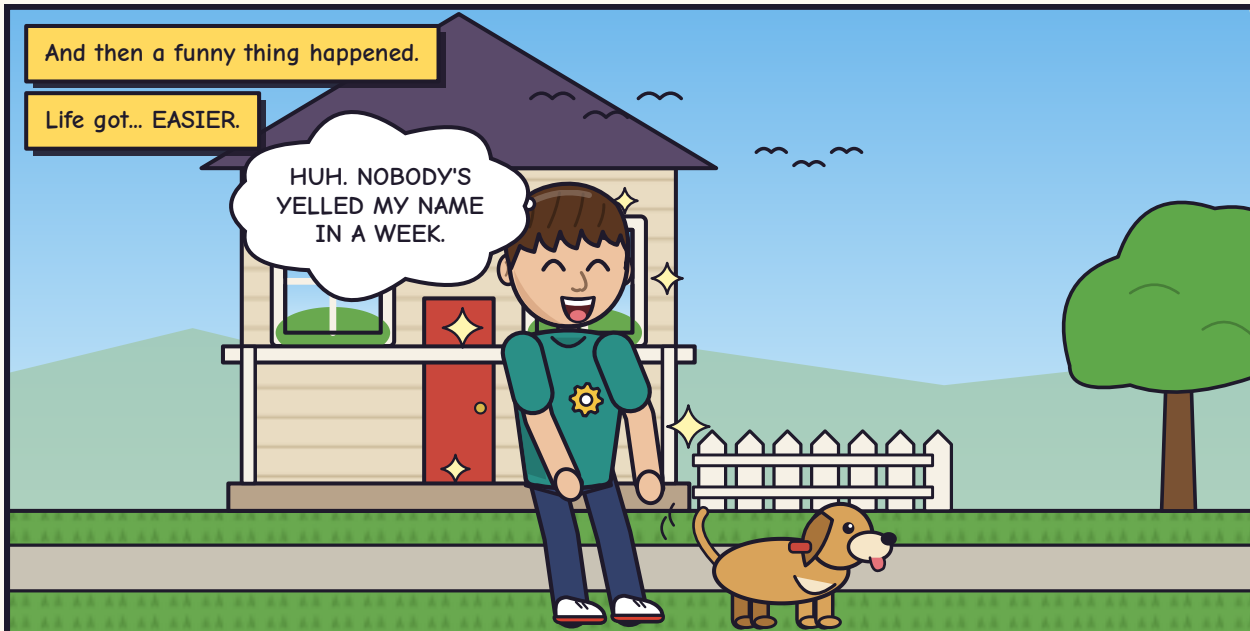




And then a funny thing happened.

Life got... EASIER.

HUH. NOBODY'S
VELLED MY NAME
IN A WEEK.

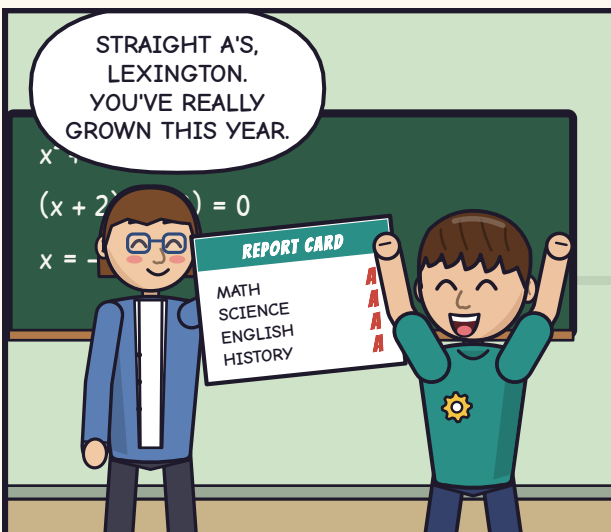


BRO... YOU
SMELL GOOD
NOW.

IT'S CALLED
SOAP. HIGHLY
RECOMMEND.



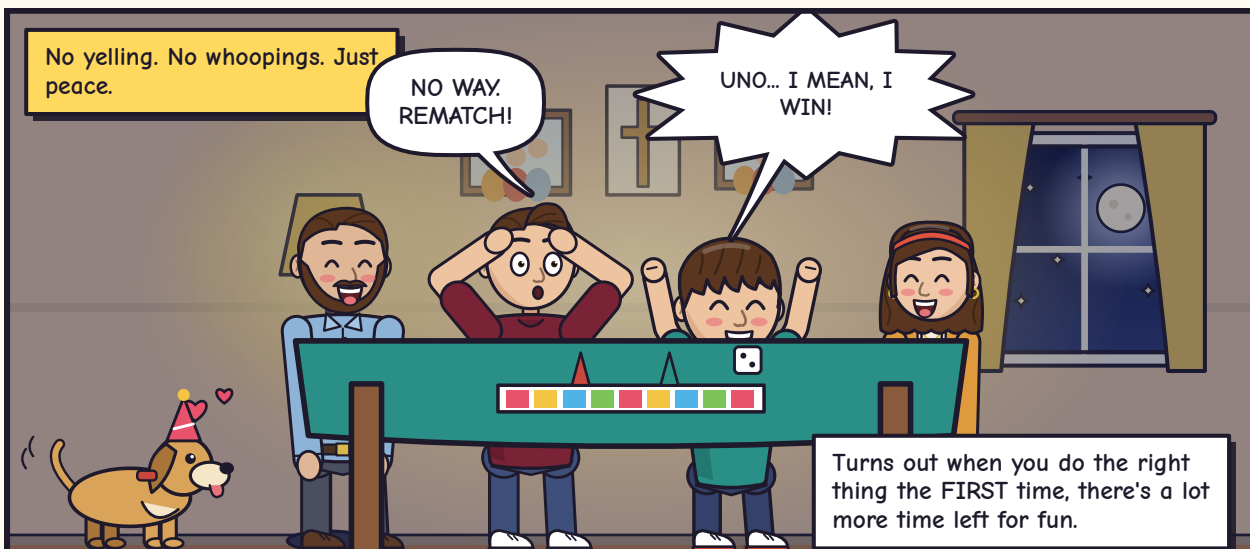
STRAIGHT A'S,
LEXINGTON.
YOU'VE REALLY
GROWN THIS YEAR.



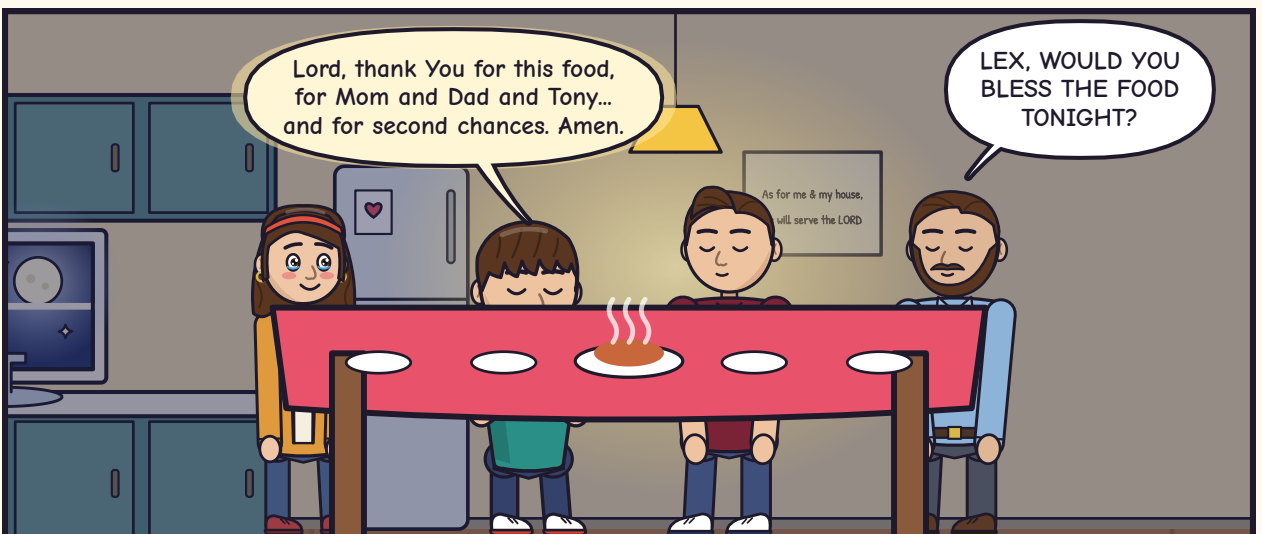
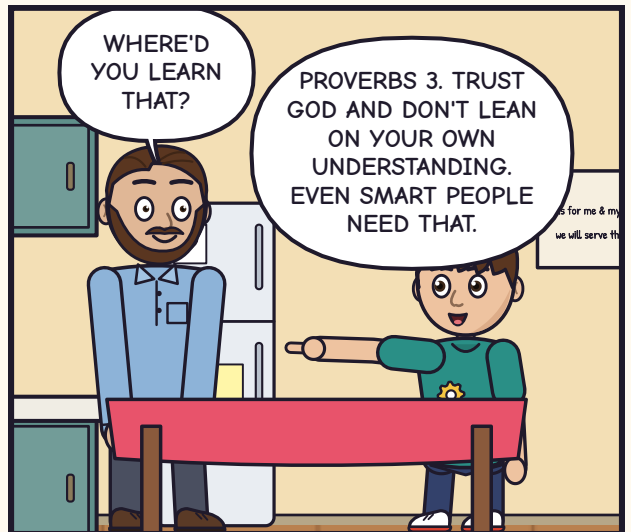
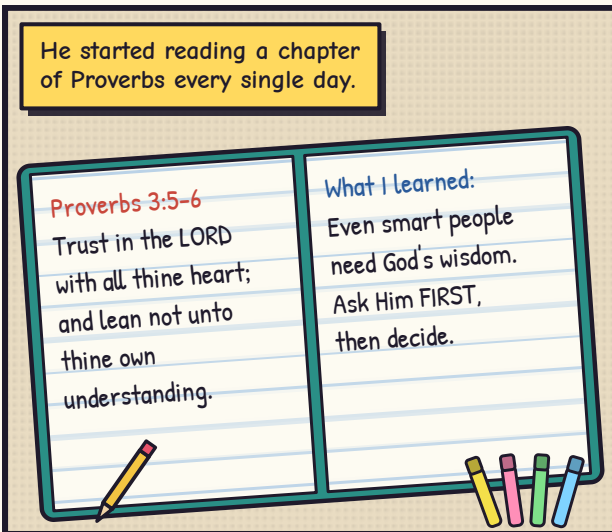
No yelling. No whoopings. Just
peace.

NO WAY.
REMATCH!

UNO... I MEAN, I
WIN!



Turns out when you do the right
thing the FIRST time, there's a lot
more time left for fun.

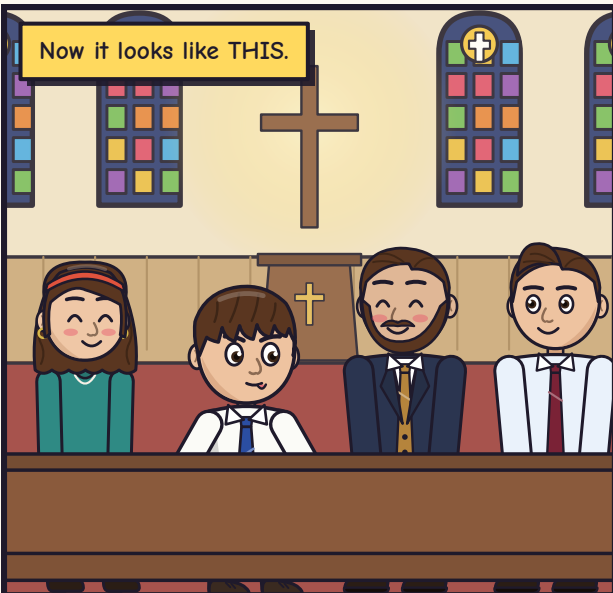


Church used to look like this...

SNORRRE



Now it looks like THIS.



GOOD MORNING,
MOTHER
JOHNSON!
WELCOME!

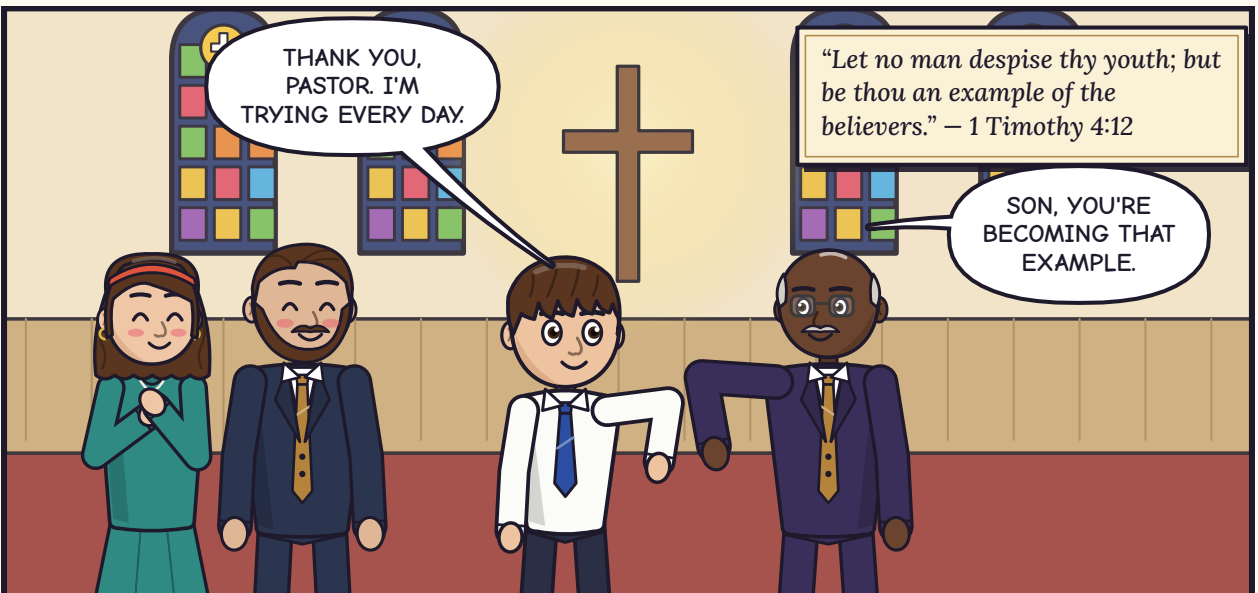
MY, MY! WHAT
A FINE YOUNG
MAN!



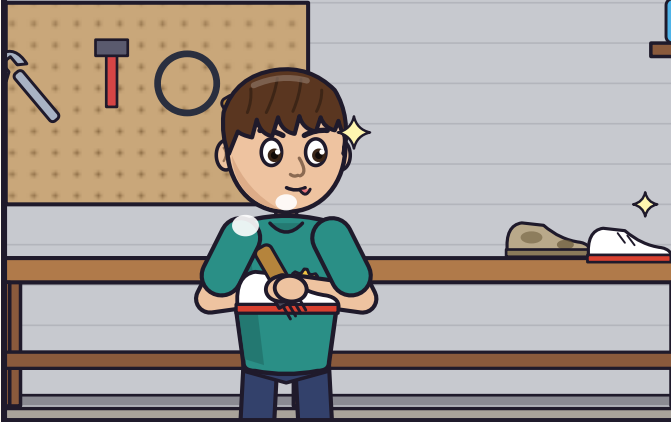
THANK YOU,
PASTOR. I'M
TRYING EVERY DAY.

"Let no man despise thy youth; but
be thou an example of the
believers." — 1 Timothy 4:12

SON, YOU'RE
BECOMING THAT
EXAMPLE.

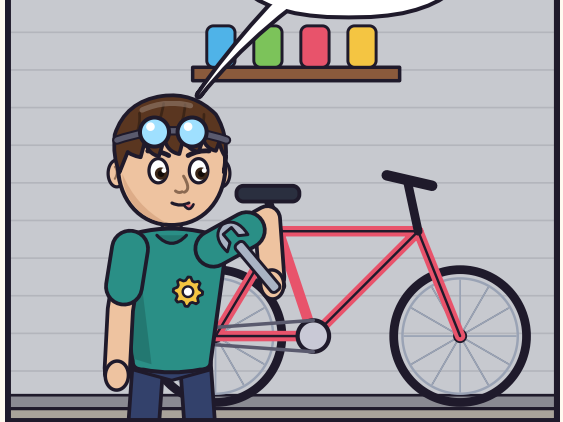


Lexington discovered two things he LOVED. Making old things look brand new...



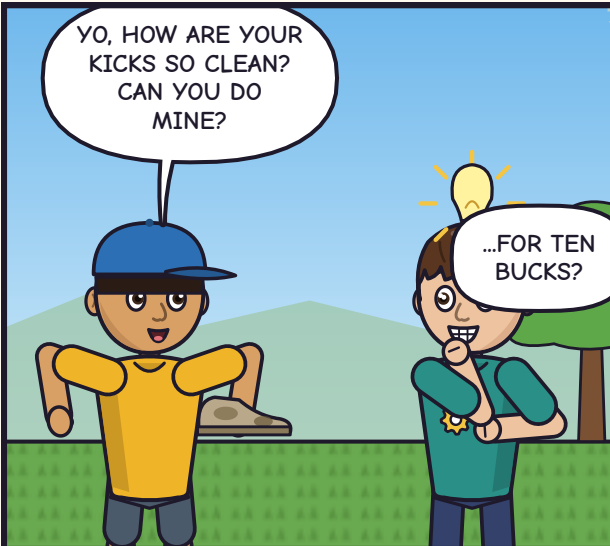
...and FIXING stuff.

BIKES ARE EASY. IT'S JUST PHYSICS.



YO, HOW ARE YOUR KICKS SO CLEAN? CAN YOU DO MINE?

...FOR TEN BUCKS?



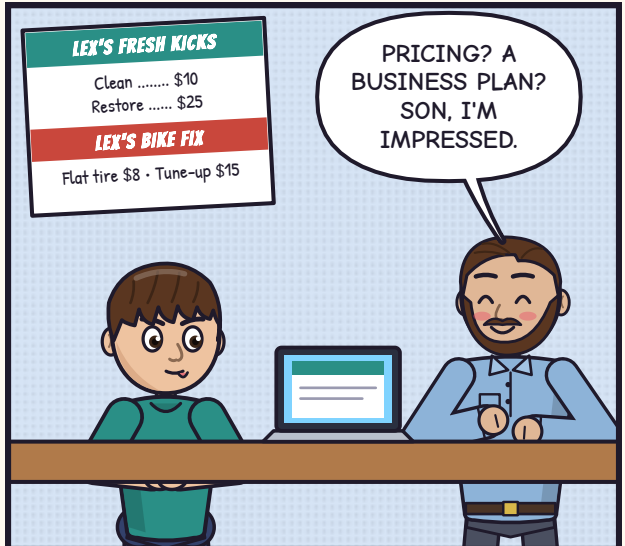
LEX'S FRESH KICKS

Clean \$10
Restore \$25

LEX'S BIKE FIX

Flat tire \$8 • Tune-up \$15

PRICING? A BUSINESS PLAN? SON, I'M IMPRESSED.

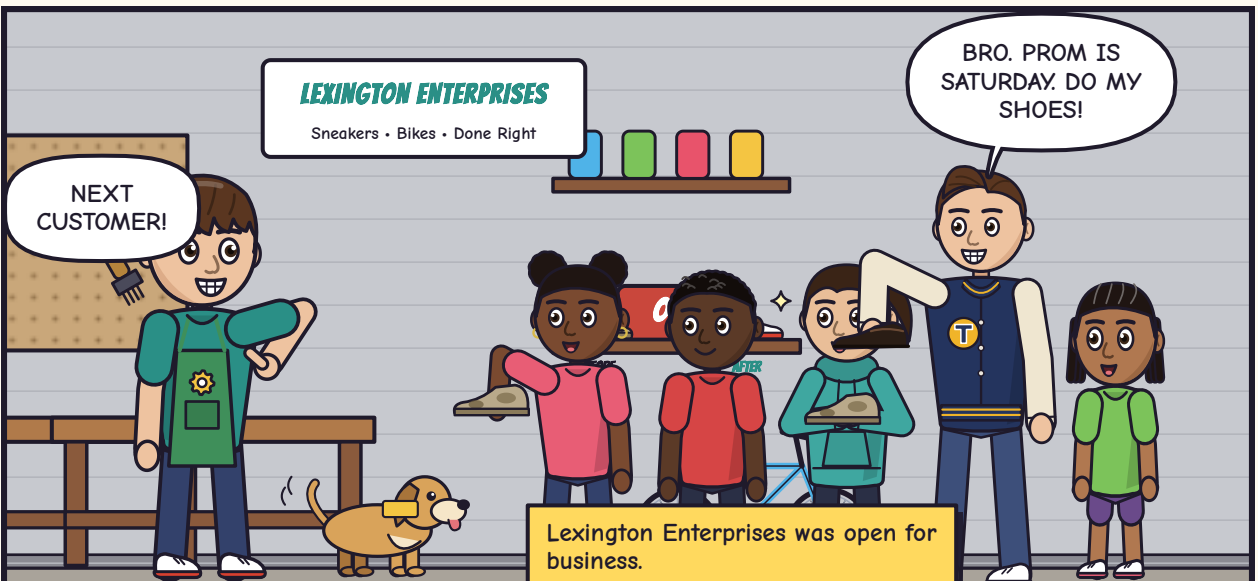


LEXINGTON ENTERPRISES

Sneakers • Bikes • Done Right

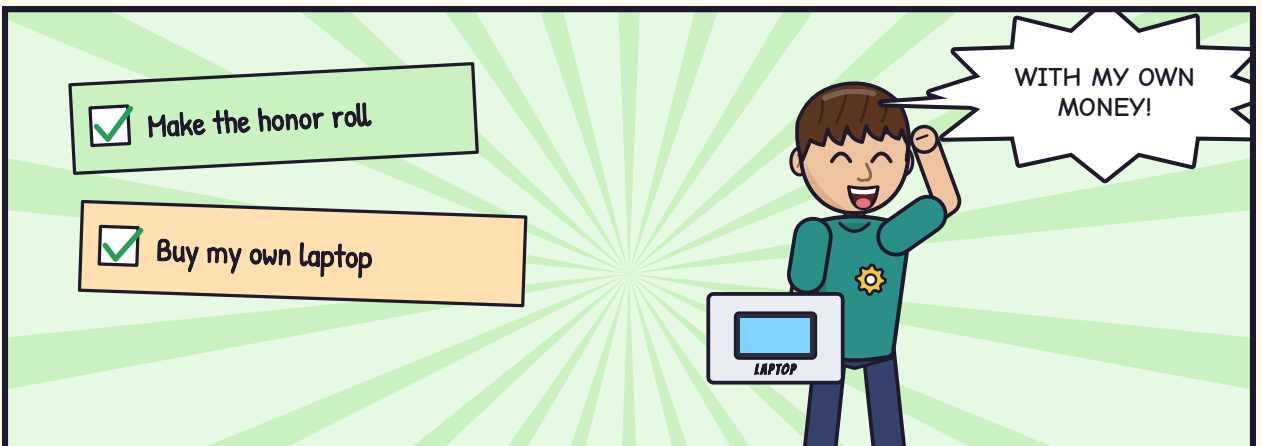
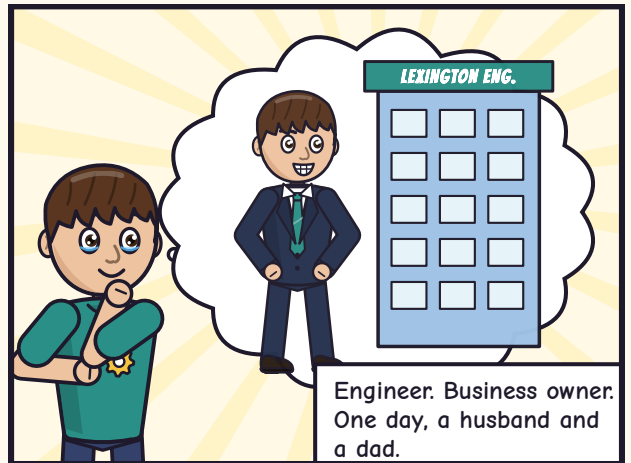
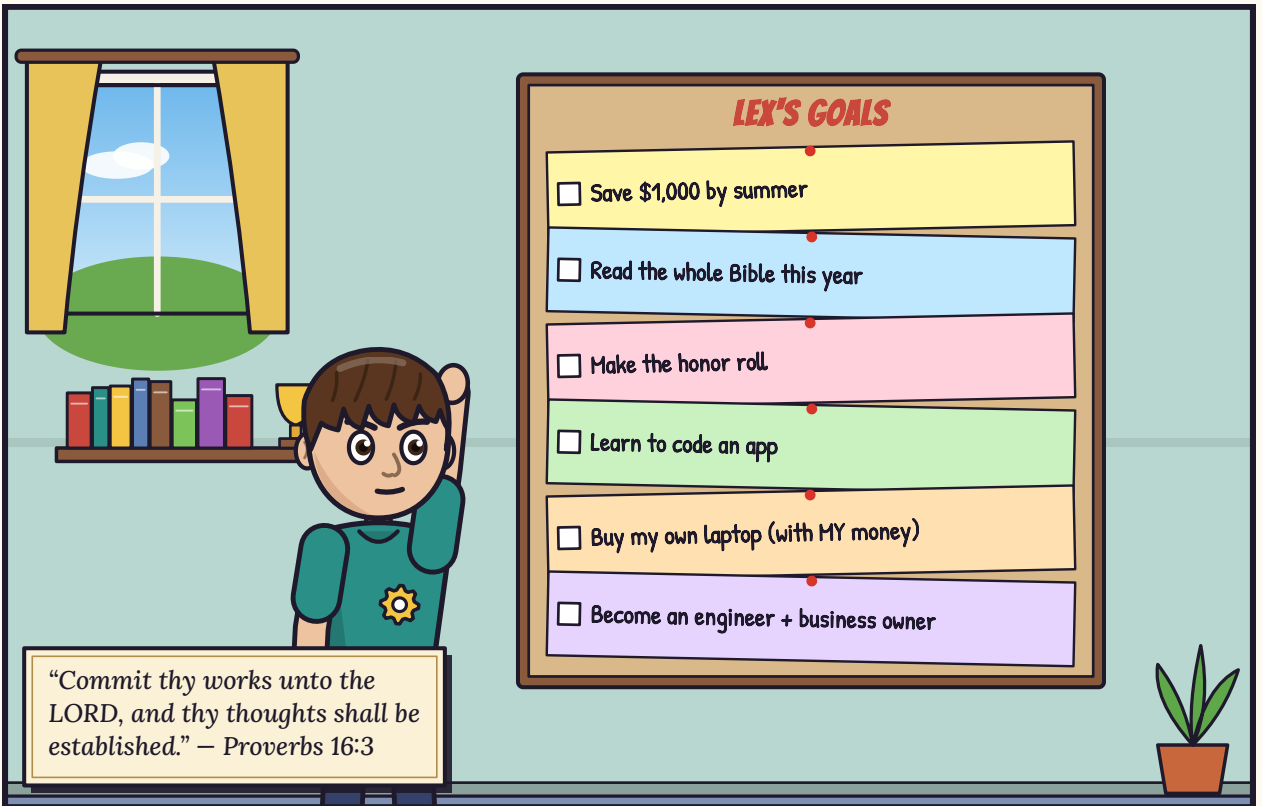
NEXT CUSTOMER!

BRO. PROM IS SATURDAY. DO MY SHOES!



Lexington Enterprises was open for business.

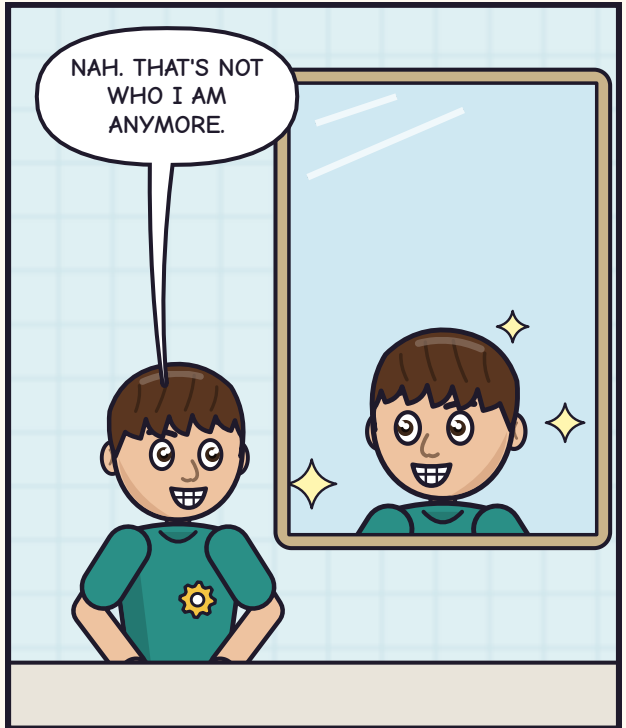




WHOA!

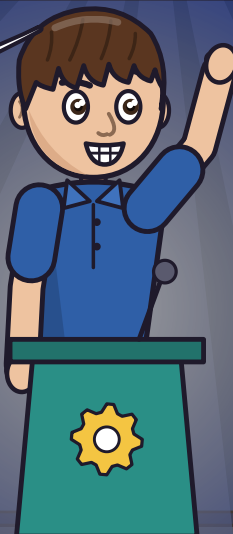


NAH. THAT'S NOT WHO I AM ANYMORE.



YOUTH BUSINESS EXPO

MY NAME IS LEXINGTON. I'M THIRTEEN... AND I RUN TWO BUSINESSES.



THAT'S OUR SON!



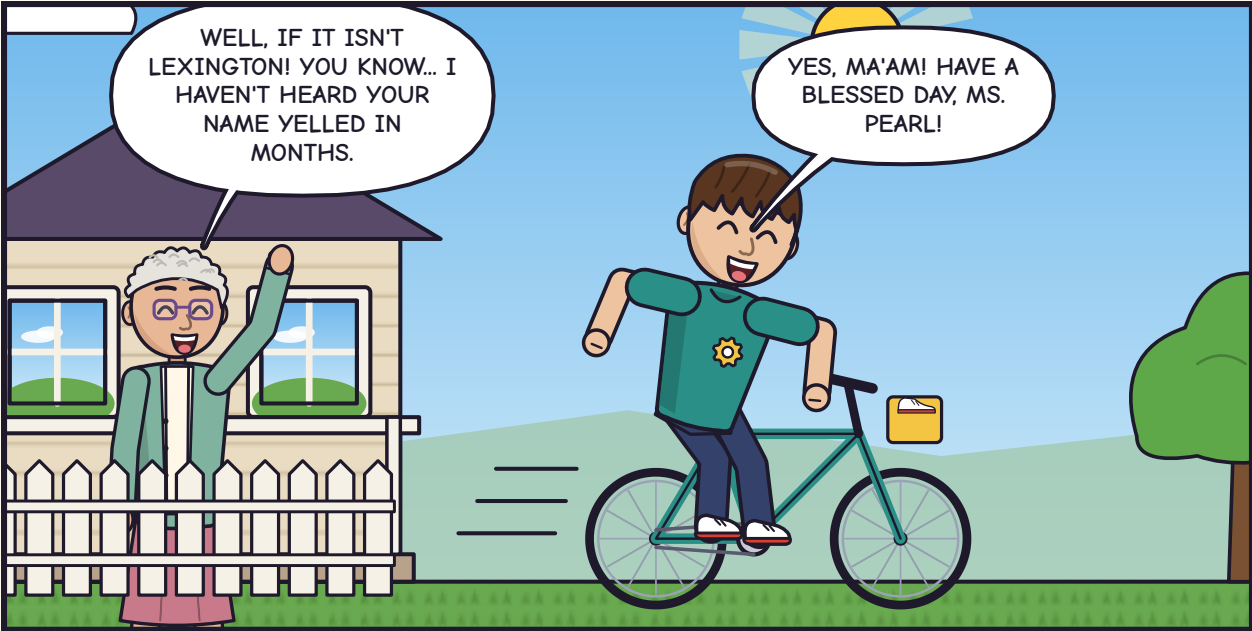
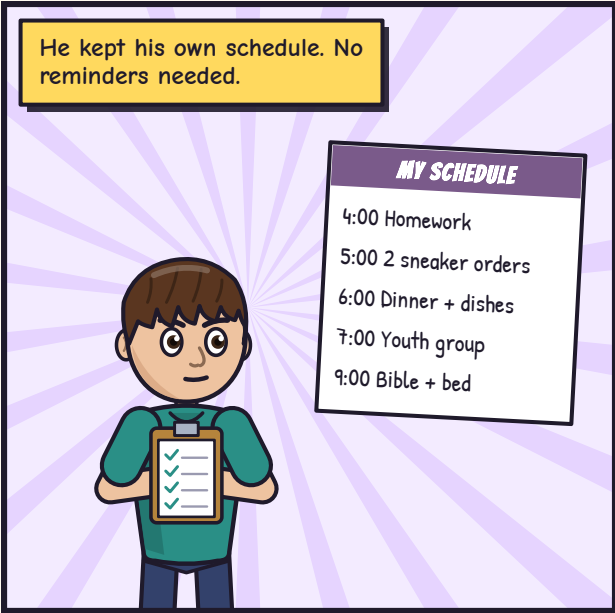
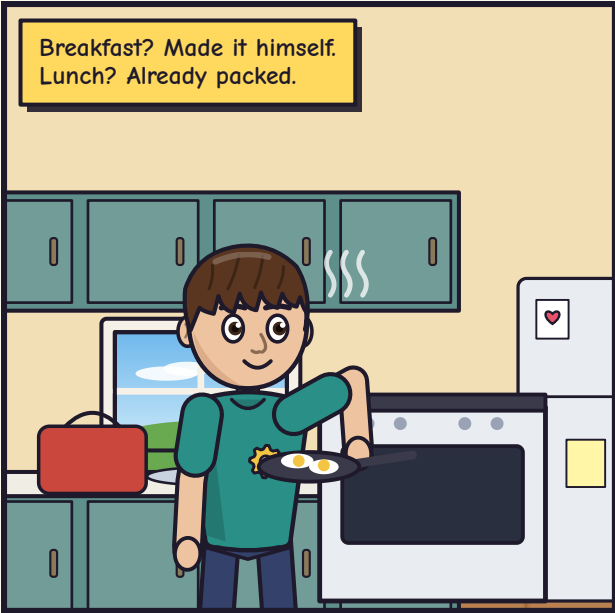
**FROM DIRTY KICKS
TO CLEAN PROFITS**



THAT'S MY LITTLE BRO!



CLAP! CLAP! CLAP!



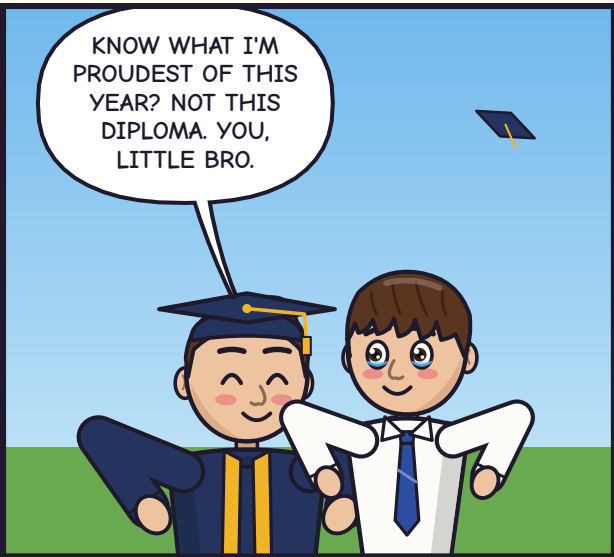
CONGRATULATIONS, CLASS OF 2021!

Graduation day.

THAT'S MY BROTHER!!!

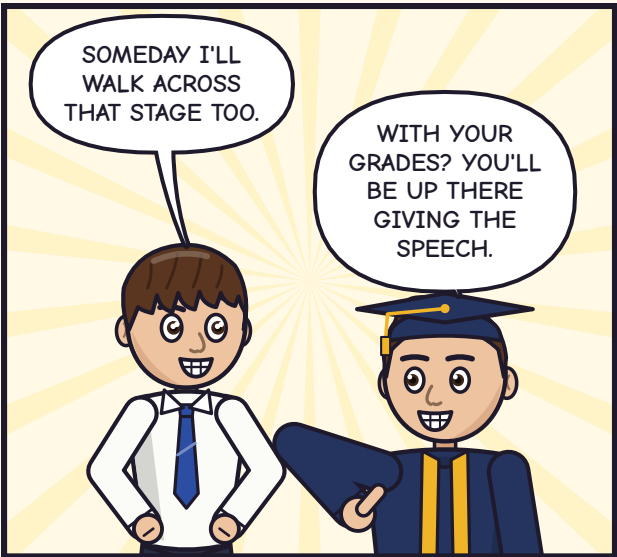


KNOW WHAT I'M PROUDEST OF THIS YEAR? NOT THIS DIPLOMA. YOU, LITTLE BRO.



SOMEDAY I'LL WALK ACROSS THAT STAGE TOO.

WITH YOUR GRADES? YOU'LL BE UP THERE GIVING THE SPEECH.



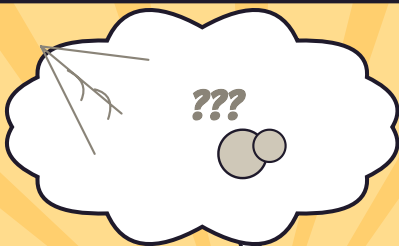
Two sons. One very proud family.

EVERYBODY SAY BLESSED!



One evening, Lexington's little cousin Jace came over.

HEY LEX... WHEN'S THE LAST TIME YOU GOT IN TROUBLE?



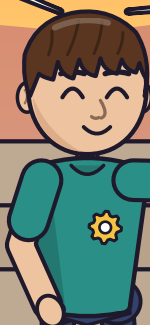
HONESTLY? I CAN'T EVEN REMEMBER.



WHAT?!



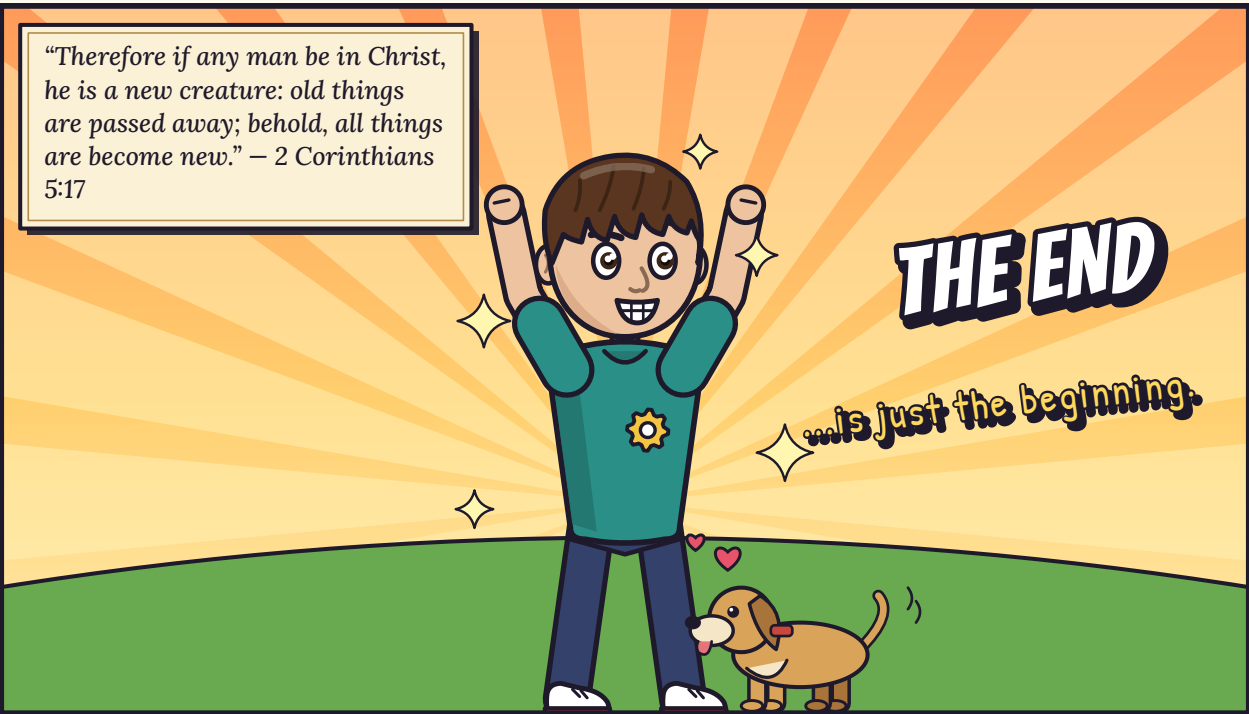
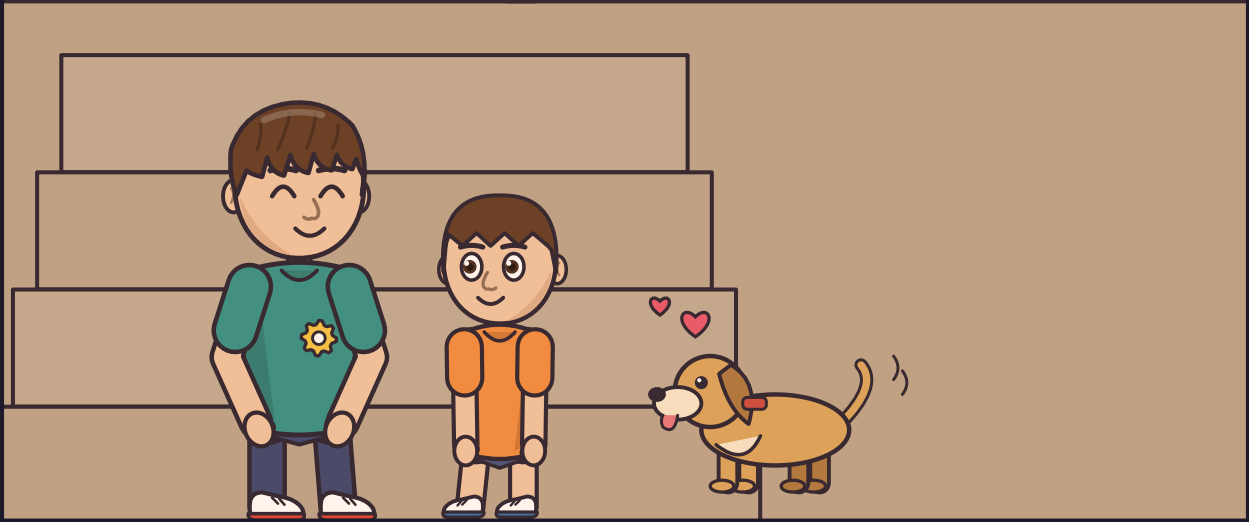
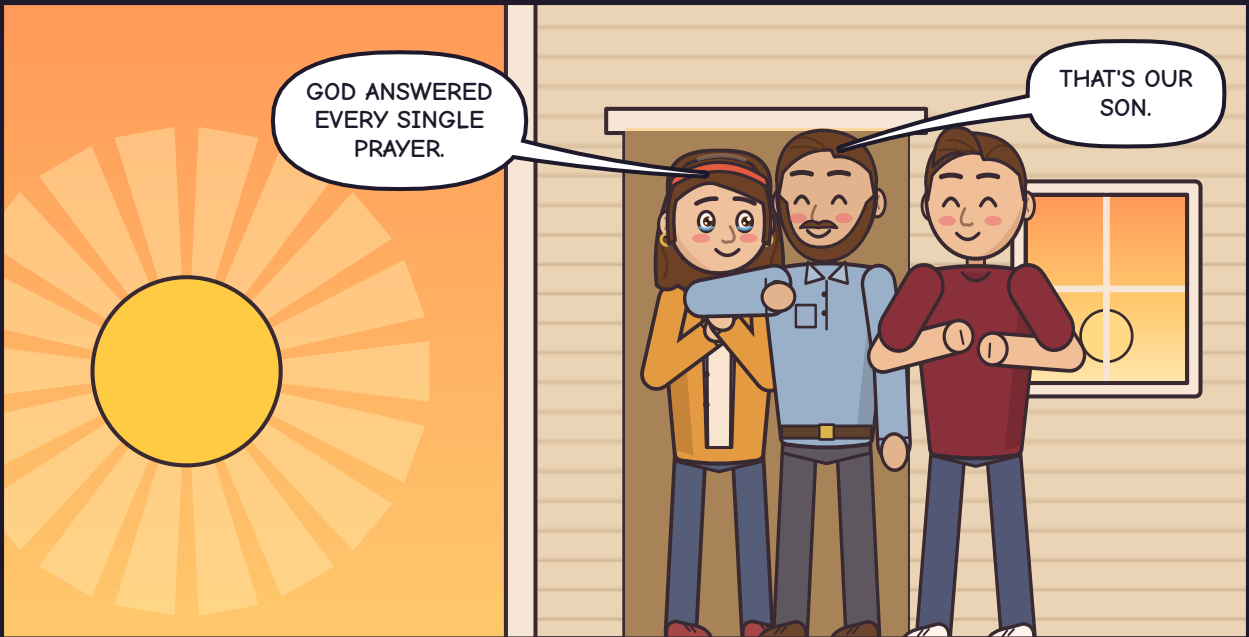
WHY WOULD I EVEN WANT TO BE IN TROUBLE? LIFE'S TOO GOOD NOW.



BUT HOW'D YOU DO IT?

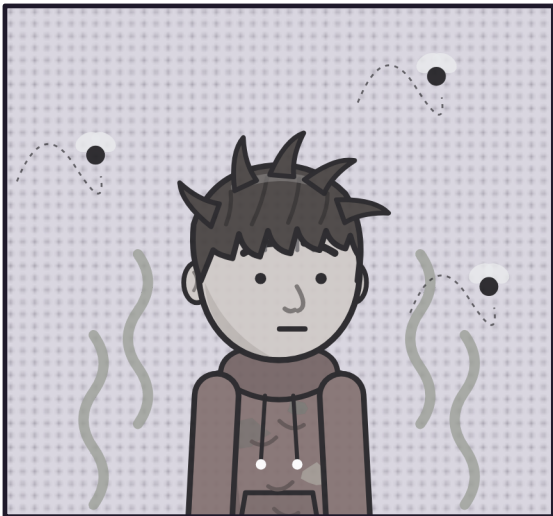
I PRAYED. I LISTENED. I KEPT GETTING BACK UP, DAY BY DAY. GOD DID THE HEAVY LIFTING. I JUST STOPPED FIGHTING HIM.





THEN & NOW

THEN



BRAINS	
LISTENING	
HYGIENE	
FAITH	
CONFIDENCE	
TROUBLE	

NOW



BRAINS	
LISTENING	
HYGIENE	
FAITH	
CONFIDENCE	
TROUBLE	

LEXINGTON'S WORDS TO LIVE BY

EPHESIANS 6:1

Children, obey your parents in the Lord: for this is right.

PHILIPPIANS 4:13

I can do all things through Christ which strengtheneth me.

GALATIANS 6:9

Let us not be weary in well doing: for in due season we shall reap.

PROVERBS 3:5

Trust in the LORD with all thine heart; and lean not unto thine own understanding.

1 TIMOTHY 4:12

Let no man despise thy youth; but be thou an example of the believers.

2 CORINTHIANS 5:17

If any man be in Christ, he is a new creature.

LEXINGTON'S DAILY CHECKLIST

Print it. Post it. Check it. Nobody has to remind you.

M T W T F S S

MORNING

Get up with the alarm	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Pray	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Brush teeth: 2 minutes	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Shower	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Deodorant	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Clean clothes + socks	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Make the bed	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

BATHROOM, EVERY TIME

Go when you first feel it	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Wipe until the paper is clean	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Flush	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Wash hands: soap, 20 seconds	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

AFTER SCHOOL

Homework first	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Chores: trash, dishes, laundry	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Feed Biscuit	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Business + hobby time	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

BEDTIME

Read a Bible chapter	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Lay out tomorrow's clothes	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Brush teeth	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Pray + lights out	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

“I can do all things through Christ.” – Phil. 4:13

